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VAGID 500

Clotrimazole Pessary 500 mg

For vaginal administration only

Composition: Each pessary contains:

Clotrimazole Ph. Eur.	500 mg
Excipients	q.s.

Dosage form: Pessary

Product description: A white opaque bullet shaped pessary

Pharmacodynamic properties:
Clotrimazole acts against fungi by inhibiting ergosterol synthesis. Inhibition of ergosterol synthesis leads to structural and functional impairment of the fungal cytoplasmic membrane. Clotrimazole has a broad antimycotic spectrum of action in vitro and in vivo, which includes dermatophytes, yeasts, moulds, etc.
Under appropriate test conditions, the MIC values for these types of fungi are in the region of less than 0.062-8.0 µg/ml substrate. The mode of action of clotrimazole is fungistatic or fungicidal depending on the concentration of clotrimazole at the site of infection. In-vitro activity is limited to proliferating fungal elements; fungal spores are only slightly sensitive. Primarily resistant variants of sensitive fungal species are very rare; the development of secondary resistance by sensitive fungi has sofar only been observed in very isolated cases under therapeutic conditions.

Pharmacokinetic properties:
Pharmacokinetic investigations after vaginal application have shown that only a small amount of clotrimazole (3 – 10% of the dose) is absorbed. Due to the rapid hepatic metabolism of absorbed clotrimazole into pharmacologically inactive metabolites the resulting peak plasma concentrations of clotrimazole after vaginal application of a 500mg dose were less than 10 ng/ml, reflecting that clotrimazole applied intravaginally does not lead to measurable systemic effects or side effects.

Indications:
Infection of the genital region (vaginitis) caused by fungi (usually Candida) and super infections caused by clotrimazole-sensitive bacteria.

Dose and method of administration:
For treatment of vaginal infections:
Single-dose treatment with VAGID 500
1 vaginal pessary to be introduced in the evening or night.
Route of administration: Vaginal
The pessary should be inserted as high as possible into the vagina. This is best achieved when lying back with legs bent up. A second treatment may be carried out if necessary. Insertion is best achieved when lying back with the legs slightly drawn up. VAGID 500 need moisture in the vagina in order to dissolve completely, otherwise undissolved pieces of the pessary might crumble out of the vagina. Pieces of undissolved pessary may be noticed by women who experience vaginal dryness. To help prevent this it is important that the pessary is inserted as high as possible into the vagina at bedtime.
Generally: Treatment during the menstrual period should not be performed due to the risk of the pessary being washed out by the menstrual flow. The treatment should be finished before the onset of menstruation. Do not use tampons, intravaginal douches, spermicides or other vaginal products while using this product. Vaginal intercourse should be avoided in case of vaginal infection and while using this product because the partner could become infected.

Contraindications:
Hypersensitivity to clotrimazole or to any ingredient in this medicine.

Precautions & warnings:
Medical advice should be sought if this is the first time the patient has experienced symptoms of candidal vaginitis. Before using VAGID 500, medical advice must be sought if any of the following are applicable:
- more than two infections of candidal vaginitis in the last 6 months.
- previous history of sexually transmitted disease or exposure to partner with sexually transmitted disease.
- pregnancy or suspected pregnancy.
- aged under 16 or over 60 years.
- known hypersensitivity to imidazoles or other vaginal antifungal products.

VAGID 500 should not be used if the patient has any of the following symptoms where upon medical advice should be sought:
- irregular vaginal bleeding.
- abnormal vaginal bleeding or a blood-stained discharge.
- vulval or vaginal ulcers, blisters or sores.
- lower abdominal pain or dysuria.
- any adverse events such as redness, irritation or swelling associated with the treatment.
- fever or chills.
- nausea or vomiting.
- diarrhoea.
- foul smelling vaginal discharge.

Patients should be advised to consult their physician if the symptoms have not been relieved within one week of using VAGID 500. VAGID 500 can be used again if the candidal infection returns after 7 days. However, if the candidal infection recurs more than twice within six months, patients should be advised to consult their physician.

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Pregnancy and breast feeding:
Pregnancy: Clotrimazole can be used during pregnancy, but only under the supervision of a physician or midwife. During pregnancy the pessary should be inserted without using an applicator.
Lactation: A decision must be made whether to discontinue breast-feeding or to discontinue/abstain from clotrimazole therapy taking into account the benefit of breast-feeding for the child and the benefit of therapy for the woman.

Interactions:
Laboratory tests have suggested that, when used together, this product may cause damage to latex contraceptives. Consequently the effectiveness of such contraceptives may be reduced. Patients should be advised to use alternative precautions for at least five days after using this product. Concomitant medication with vaginal clotrimazole and oral tacrolimus (FK-506; immunosuppressant) might lead to increased tacrolimus plasma levels and similarly with sirolimus. Patients should thus be closely monitored for signs and symptoms of tacrolimus or sirolimus overdosage, if necessary by determination of the respective plasma levels.

Adverse effects:
As the listed undesirable effects are based on spontaneous reports, assigning accurate frequency of occurrence for each is not possible.
Immune system disorders: Allergic reaction (syncope, hypotension, dyspnea, urticaria, pruritus).
Reproductive system and breast disorders: Genital peeling, pruritus, rash, oedema, erythema, discomfort, burning, irritation, pelvic pain, vaginal haemorrhage.
Gastrointestinal disorders: Abdominal pain.

Overdose:
No risk of acute intoxication is seen as it is unlikely to occur following a single vaginal or dermal application of an overdose (application over a large area under conditions favourable to absorption) or inadvertent oral ingestion. There is no specific antidote.
However, in the event of accidental oral ingestion, routine measures such as gastric lavage should be performed only if clinical symptoms of overdose become apparent (e.g. dizziness, nausea or vomiting). Gastric lavage should be carried out only if the airway can be protected adequately.

Storage:
Store in dry place below 30°C. Do not freeze. Keep out of reach of children.
Not to be taken orally. For vaginal administration only. Only under prescription.

Packaging: A Strip of 1 pessary with applicator.

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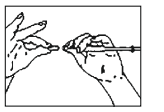
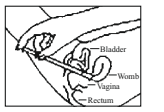
How to use Pessary



1. Remove the applicator from the packaging. Pull out the plunger as far as the backstop. Remove one pessary from the blister and place firmly into the applicator. Pessary fits tightly into the applicator and needs to be squeezed into the holder just far enough to be held in place during insertion (about 1 cm.)

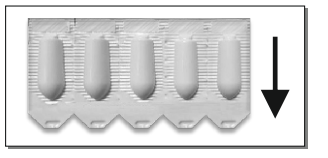


2. Carefully insert the applicator as deep as is comfortable into the vagina. Holding the applicator in place, slowly press the plunger until it stops so that the pessary is inserted into the vagina.
3. If the pessary is too soft, it may be chilled in the refrigerator or under cold running water before unwrapping.
4. Carefully remove the applicator. Dispose of the applicator in a safe place, out of the reach of children.

   The applicator cannot be flushed down the toilet.

Disposal Instructions
- Dispose of unused or expired pessaries responsibly, following local regulations for medical or pharmaceutical waste.
- If no specific disposal programs exist, wrap the product securely and dispose of it with general household waste, as per local guidelines.

KEEP THE PESSARY ALWAYS IN UPDOWN POSITION AS SHOWN ON THE PACK.



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